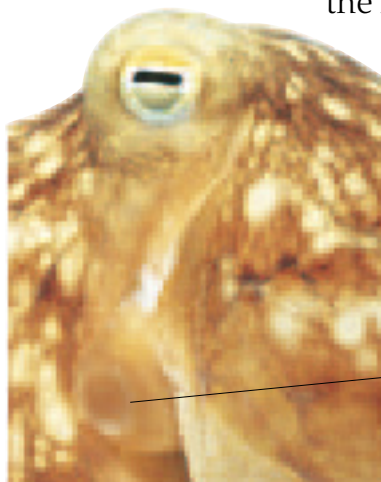


The jet set

ONE WAY TO GET AROUND QUICKLY in water is by jet propulsion. Some mollusks, such as clams, squid, and octopuses, do this by squirting water from the body cavity. Jet propulsion can be used both for swimming and to help mollusks escape from predators. Squid are best at jet propulsion—their bodies are permanently streamlined to reduce drag (resistance to water). Some kinds of scallops also use jet propulsion and are among the few clams that can swim. Most clams (bivalves with shells in two halves) can only bury themselves in the sand, or are anchored to the seabed. The common octopus lives on the rocky seabed in the coastal waters of the Atlantic Ocean, and the Mediterranean and Caribbean seas. If attacked, it can jet off.



JET PROPULSION
The engines powering jet planes produce jets of air to fly in much the same way that octopuses, squid, and cuttlefish produce jets of water to propel themselves through the sea.



TENTACLE TALES
A Norwegian story tells of the Kraken, a giant sea monster that wrapped its arms around ships before sinking them. The legend may be based on the mysterious giant squid which live in deep waters. Dead individuals sometimes are seen washed up on the shore. In 2004 the first living one was caught in the depths by one of its tentacles and photographed as it escaped.

FLEXIBLE FUNNEL
Sticking out from the edge of the octopus's baglike body is its funnel. The funnel can be bent so the jet of water can be aimed backward or forward, to control the direction in which the octopus heads off.

Funnel

Long arms to grasp prey

Powerful suckers grip the rock, so octopus can pull itself along

ON THE BOTTOM
The common octopus hides during the day in its rocky lair, coming out at night to look for such food as crustaceans. The octopus slowly approaches its prey, then pounces, wrapping it between the webbing at the base of its arms.

Sucker is sensitive to touch and taste

